



Providing Creative Solutions to Common Problems

TENANT BALANCES & RENTAL RECEIVABLES · CAPABILITIES OVERVIEW

Receivables Recovery for Rental Owners

Recovering unpaid rent, damages and balances after move-out — on pure contingency, with credit-bureau reporting through Experian RentBureau

Prepared for **Kevin Tillery Homes** · August 2026

A recovery partner for the balances that walk out with the tenant

To Kevin — thank you for reaching out. On a buy-and-hold portfolio the losses that hurt most are the ones that leave with the keys: the last two months of unpaid rent, the damage that swallowed the deposit and then some, the tenant whose phone stops working the week after move-out.

A vacated balance is not a lost cause — it is an unworked account. You told us \$10,000–\$100,000 is outstanding. Most owners write balances like these off because chasing a former tenant across state lines is not a job an owner-operator has time for.

Southwest Recovery Services is an outsourced receivables recovery partner working rental balances on **pure contingency since 2004**. You place accounts through a secure portal, and we work them — including skip tracing to find a tenant who has already moved on. No recovery, no fee.

Two decades of rental recovery — nationwide

Recovery reach across all 50 states, which matters for a New Jersey-based owner running an Akron portfolio and chasing tenants who rarely stay local.

2004 Recovering commercial receivables since	\$975M+ Receivables placed (all industries)	\$76M+ Recovered for clients	800K+ Accounts worked
52% of placed accounts see a recovery	50 states — nationwide recovery reach	4.9★ Google client rating	\$0 upfront — no recovery, no fee

Commercial & B2B collections since 2004

Nationwide — all 50 states

12 offices across 7 states

Skip tracing on businesses & principals

Contingency — no recovery, no fee

RECOGNIZED & FEATURED BY

USA TODAY

FINANCIAL SERVICES
Review

FSR • TOP 10 LIST
2025 Recognition

INTERNATIONAL
Business Times

CFO Tech
Outlook

insideARM

ACCREDITED & RECOGNIZED



 ★ 4.9 · 38 Google reviews

Memberships: **ACA International** · TAA · AAGD · NARPM

The questions a rental owner actually asks

You told us you are carrying \$10,000–\$100,000 in outstanding balances across a rental portfolio. Here is exactly how that gets worked.

YOUR QUESTION	SOUTHWEST RECOVERY SERVICES
1. Fee structure	Pure contingency — \$0 upfront, no retainer, no monthly minimum. You pay a pre-agreed percentage only of what we actually recover. On a book your size that means the write-offs you are already carrying cost you nothing to attempt.
2. Tenants who have moved on	The core of rental recovery. Skip tracing locates a former tenant who has changed address, phone and employer — the single biggest reason owners give up on these balances. A national reach matters here; a tenant who left Akron rarely stays in Akron.
3. Credit reporting	This is the leverage most owners do not have on their own. Reportable balances go to Equifax and Experian , including Experian RentBureau , which is specific to rental history and is checked by the next landlord screening that tenant. It is often what turns an ignored balance into a paid one.
4. Unpaid rent vs. damages	Two different arguments. Unpaid rent is documented by the lease and the ledger; damages need the move-out inspection, photographs and itemized costs. We work both, and the strength of your file decides how hard each can be pushed — which is why placement documentation matters so much.
Compliance	Rental balances are consumer debt under the FDCPA and Reg F, and we work them inside those rules by design. That protects you: an owner who hands accounts to an aggressive collector inherits the liability. Note we do not work consumer accounts in CA, OR or WA; Minnesota is restricted.

Simple placement, full visibility

Every placement runs through our secure portal — built so an owner-operator can place accounts in minutes and see what is happening without chasing anyone for an update.

SPREADSHEET-READY PLACEMENT

Upload a simple list or a property-management export — we map your columns, no re-keying, no new software to learn.

REAL-TIME REPORTING

Run and export account and recovery reports on demand — live status on every placed balance across every property.

SECURE FILE EXCHANGE

Send leases, ledgers, move-out inspections and damage photographs safely inside the portal — the documentation that makes a balance collectable.

DIRECT-PAYMENT REPORTING

Log payments a former tenant sends you directly, so balances stay accurate and nobody is contacted after paying.

► **Portal Video Tour**

SWRS Rental & Property Recovery Case Studies

Actual placed-versus-recovered results from Southwest Recovery's rental and property-management book, anonymized and sized to an owner-operator portfolio. The spread is shown honestly, weaker results included — recovery on a vacated balance depends heavily on file quality and how quickly it is placed.

SINGLE-FAMILY RENTAL

OPERATOR

Owner-operator portfolio

\$31.5K recovered

of ~\$31K placed

100% recovered

MULTIFAMILY OPERATOR

Apartment portfolio

\$114.6K recovered

of ~\$170K placed

67% recovered

PROPERTY INVESTMENT

GROUP

Regional holdings

\$29.3K recovered

of ~\$43K placed

69% recovered

RESIDENTIAL HOMES

OPERATOR

Scattered-site rentals

\$4.8K recovered

of ~\$11K placed

43% recovered

PROPERTY MANAGEMENT

FIRM

Third-party manager

\$20.4K recovered

of ~\$106K placed

19% recovered

PROPERTY HOLDINGS

COMPANY

Aged tenant book

\$6.3K recovered

of ~\$33K placed

19% recovered

Anonymized by sector from Southwest Recovery's book; individual client names withheld. Results vary by account age, balance, documentation quality and industry. We do not publish blended portfolio averages.

**WHY FILE QUALITY DECIDES A
VACATED BALANCE**

The lease and the move-out file are worth more than the chase

The gap between the 100% and the 19% above is rarely effort — it is documentation and timing. A balance placed soon after move-out, with a signed lease, a clean ledger and an itemized damage file, is a fundamentally different account from one placed two years later on a handshake.

WHAT MAKES A BALANCE COLLECTABLE

Signed lease, itemized ledger, move-out inspection with dated photographs, forwarding address and employer if known — each one raises the recoverable share.

THE STANDING RULE

Place at move-out plus 30–60 days rather than at write-off. Contact data is still warm and the tenant has not yet re-established elsewhere.

Recovery figures vary by portfolio; SWRS gives an honest, age-based read on a representative sample before any accounts are worked.

We speak your ledger

A scattered-site rental portfolio creates a specific recovery profile — modest balances, tenants who relocate, and an owner with no collections department. Our playbook is built for that.



Unpaid rent after move-out

The last months owed once the unit is already re-let — documented from the lease and ledger and pursued nationally.



Damages beyond the deposit

Itemized repair costs supported by your move-out inspection, argued properly rather than written off with the security deposit.



Skip tracing on former tenants

Locating a tenant who changed address, phone and employer — the step most owners simply cannot perform themselves.



Experian RentBureau reporting

Rental-specific credit reporting the next landlord will see at screening — leverage an individual owner has no other way to apply.

Recovery run on an AI-driven platform — Aktos

Every account SWRS works runs on Aktos, a next-generation, AI-driven collections platform — with compliance built into the workflow, not bolted on afterward. It's how a boutique, people-first agency delivers enterprise-grade speed, consistency, and auditability.



AI workflow automation

Repetitive steps are automated and every account is scored and routed by predicted payment likelihood — so the right strategy reaches the right account first, without manual queue-picking.



Omnichannel outreach

Coordinated email, SMS, and voice, timed to when a debtor is most likely to engage — replacing high-friction call blasts with respectful, data-driven contact.



Compliance built in

FDCPA, Reg F, and TCPA guardrails are enforced inside the automation, with phone-number and consent checks before outreach — documented and defensible on every account.



Real-time dashboards

You see status, segmentation, and recovery performance on your portfolio in real time — full transparency, not a monthly PDF.



API-first intake

Secure SFTP/API placement means accounts start working without data lag — roughly 50% faster acknowledgment and validation of new placements.



Data-driven scoring

Dynamic scoring and segmentation predict payment likelihood and concentrate effort where recovery is most achievable — earlier intervention that returns more of each aging balance and reduces disputes.

The result is the combination clients rarely get from a legacy agency: faster cash and cleaner compliance at the same time. Automation accelerates recovery and standardizes documentation, while empathy-first, data-driven contact protects your brand and keeps disputes and complaints low.

Built by a collector with 30 years on the phones — not a CEO with zero collection experience



Steven Dietz

Founder & Chief Executive Officer

Featured in USA Today, International Business Times & Financial Services Review — Top AR Management Service, 2025 · ACA International member.

Steven Dietz didn't come to collections from the corner office — he came from the phones. He started as a collector and credit analyst before he was 20, was tapped by Aaron's to train collectors across 100+ locations, and has spent nearly 30 years in receivables. He became convinced the industry's bad reputation was a choice, not a requirement.

He founded Southwest Recovery Services in 2004 on that principle — a national, family-owned receivables partner that treats every debtor as a person. Two decades later he still coaches the teams and works accounts personally.

Regardless of the means of recovery, our focus is always on preserving goodwill and representing the client professionally.

— Steven Dietz, Founder & Chief Executive Officer, Southwest Recovery Services

A former tenant is still someone's neighbour, and rental balances are consumer debt — so recovery stays firm and compliant, never aggressive. That protects the owner as much as the tenant.

Take it with you

Download this overview and the supporting white papers to share with your team.



This capabilities overview

PDF · prepared for Kevin Tillery Homes

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The Placement-File Standard

Maximizing recovery · PDF

[Download PDF ↓](#)



Fair Debt Collection Practices — What Businesses Should Know

Consumer balances · PDF

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The Aktos Advantage

Our AI-driven collections platform · PDF

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The Experian Intelligence Advantage

Data & skip-tracing stack · PDF

[Download PDF ↓](#)



The Recovery Waterfall

Full recovery lifecycle · PDF

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Let's turn those written-off tenant balances back into cash.

A 30-minute call with Hunter Howard to walk your outstanding list, confirm what documentation you hold, and put a contingency rate against a representative sample.

[Book a 30-minute discovery call →](#)

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12 offices across 7 states · nationwide recovery. Private & confidential — prepared for Kevin Tillery Homes. FDCPA / CFPB / FCRA compliant · ACA International member.